

Ecowarriors Initiative

2025

Annual Impact Report

Kickout Period Poverty

28th – May

Launched: May 28, 2025 (International Menstrual Hygiene Day) Strategic Focus: Men's Engagement, Stigma Reduction, and Rural Support.

- **Breaking the Silence:** This initiative was launched with a bold goal: to bring men and boys to the table. By involving male allies, including our Goodwill Ambassador Denis Omedi, Uganda Cranes Football Player we are successfully shifting the narrative from "a girl's problem" to a community responsibility.
- **Targeted Impact: Engagement:** men and boys participated in stigma-reduction workshops.
 - Safe Spaces: Created "Period-Friendly" environments in 8 rural schools where girls feel supported rather than shamed.
 - Reusable sanitary pads were served to rural girls
 - Menstrual Bracelets were served to men as sign of support to girls
- **Why It Matters:** Involving men is the key to reducing the cultural stigma that often prevents girls from accessing the products and support they need.



2. Climate Action: My Period, My Tree

Award-Winning Innovation: My Period, My Tree

Our flagship initiative, My Period, My Tree, was honored on the national stage at the UN Youth Awards 2025. It was recognized as the Best Initiative from Eastern Uganda for its unique intersection of Health and Climate Action.

- The Concept: We integrate menstrual health with reforestation by encouraging girls and their families to plant trees as a symbol of growth and sustainability.
- The Impact: By linking a girl's period to the planting of a tree, we are nurturing a generation that views environmental care as a lifelong commitment.
- Target Audience: Rural school girls, youth, and community leaders in Eastern Uganda.
- 2025 Goal: 100 fruit trees planted to combat local deforestation and improve soil health.

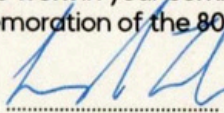


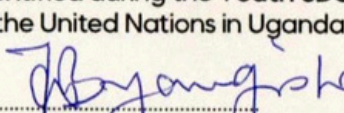
CERTIFICATE OF RECOGNITION

THIS CERTIFICATE IS PROUDLY PRESENTED TO

UGANDA ECOWARRIORS INITIATIVE

For the outstanding SDGs work in your community identified during the Youth SDGs awards 2025
in Commemoration of the 80 years of the United Nations in Uganda.


Mr. Leonard Zulu
UN Resident Coordinator


Dr. Albert Byamugisha
Head of SdG secretariat

3. Education & Advocacy: Shaping Tomorrow's Leaders

Target Audience: Student leaders, UNSA members, and school administrators.

Our partnership with the Shared Sights Foundation allowed us to go deep into the hearts of rural schools to mentor the next generation of decision-makers.

- The Leadership Workshop at St. Stephen's SS: We conducted an intensive Leadership and SDG awareness workshop specifically for 100 school prefects and UNSA members at St. Stephen's SS. These are the young leaders who set the tone for their peers.
- Inclusivity at the Core: A major focus of our training was Disability Inclusiveness. We challenged these student leaders to ensure that their leadership styles and school environments are welcoming and accessible to students with disabilities.
- SDG Advocacy: We empowered these 100 leaders to become "SDG Ambassadors," giving them the tools to promote Global Goals within their school community, focusing on Equality, Health, and Climate Action.



4. Environment: The "Waste to Wealth" Initiative

Target Audience: Students and youth innovators.

Environmental sustainability became a hands-on reality this year through our Waste to Wealth program. We believe that solving the plastic crisis requires both a change in mindset and a set of practical skills.

- Creative Transformation at St. Stephen's SS: We engaged 150 students in an intensive "Waste to Wealth" training session. The focus was on turning common environmental pollutants—specifically plastic water bottles—into high-value, innovative products.
- From Bottles to Jewelry: Students learned the technical process of repurposing plastic into sustainable jewelry and other functional materials. This training didn't just clean up the school compound; it provided students with the foundations of green entrepreneurship.
- Global Expertise: Collaborating with our volunteer from Spain, Pablo, we introduced international best practices in waste management, showing these 80 students that their local actions have global significance.

Impact Metric: 80 Students Trained in circular economy skills, turning plastic waste into wearable art and sustainable solutions.



5. WASH & Sanitation: The World Toilet Day Community Clean-Up

Focus: Dignity in Sanitation and Menstrual Hygiene.

On World Toilet Day, we moved beyond advocacy and took direct action to improve the health and dignity of our community. We believe that a clean toilet is a basic human right, especially for those who menstruate and require safe, private, and hygienic spaces.

- Broad Community Reach: Our team and volunteers organized intensive clean-up exercises across five local schools and the main public hospital.
- The WASH Connection: By focusing on sanitation, we raised critical awareness about the WASH framework. We educated the community on how clean facilities reduce the spread of diseases and provide the necessary environment for girls to manage their periods with dignity.
- Impact by the Numbers:
 - 6 Major Institutions: Cleaned and sanitized (5 Schools + 1 Public Hospital).
 - Awareness Created: Reached hundreds of students, patients, and staff with messages on the importance of maintaining hygienic sanitation facilities.
 - Dignity Restored: Ensured that those who menstruate have access to a clean, safe environment, reducing the risk of infection and school absenteeism.



6. Eco Digital Project: Bridging the Digital Divide

Target Audience: Rural youth and women.

In today's world, digital skills are the gateway to opportunity. This year, we took a bold step toward closing the digital gap in rural communities through a high-impact partnership with the MTN Foundation and Maendeleo Foundation.

- **The 10-Day Technical Intensive:** We conducted a rigorous, hands-on digital literacy drive focused on equipping participants with practical computer skills, internet proficiency, and digital tools for business.
- **Empowering 140 Visionaries:** A total of 140 youth and women successfully completed the program. These participants are no longer just observers of the digital age—they are active participants.
- **Certified for Success:** To ensure long-term value, each of the 140 participants was awarded a certificate of completion. This credential serves as a vital tool for their resumes, helping them unlock new employment opportunities and entrepreneurial ventures.

"Giving a woman or a youth a digital skill is like giving them a key to the global market. With 140 newly certified digital citizens, the future of our rural economy looks brighter than ever."



7. Youth in Service: The Power of Volunteering

Location: Budondo Health Center IV Public Hospital **Target:** Community Health & Youth Mobilization

At the heart of our mission is the belief that young people are not just the leaders of tomorrow, but the change-makers of today. To prove this, we organized a massive Hospital Clean-Up Drive designed to showcase the transformative power of volunteerism.

- **Mobilizing for the SDGs:** This wasn't just about cleaning; it was about action toward the Sustainable Development Goals. By improving the hygiene of a public health facility, our youth directly contributed to community health and well-being.
- **40 Youth, One Mission:** We successfully brought together 40 dedicated young volunteers who donated their time and energy to sanitize the hospital grounds.
- **Inspiring a New Generation:** The event served as a powerful lesson in civic responsibility. These 40 youth walked away with a deeper understanding of how collective action can solve local problems and create a cleaner, safer environment for patients and healthcare workers alike.

"When 40 young people put aside their day to clean a public hospital, it sends a message that our community's health is everyone's business. This is the power of the SDGs in action."



8. Preventative Health: Fighting NCDs through Play

Target Audience: Primary School Learners **Focus:** SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being)

We believe that healthy habits start early. To address the rising threat of Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) such as diabetes and heart disease, we launched a vibrant Physical Exercise (PE) campaign targeting primary school children.

- **Awareness through Action:** Instead of just teaching theory, we engaged hundreds of kids in organized physical exercises. We used these sessions to educate them on the importance of staying active and maintaining a healthy lifestyle.
- **Building Lifelong Habits:** By making fitness fun, we are empowering the youngest members of our community to take charge of their long-term health, reducing the future burden of NCDs in our region.



9. Sustainable Solutions & Community Dialogue

Partners: Hug Foundation & Buyala Primary School

We believe that providing supplies is only half the battle; providing skills and conversation creates lasting change.

- **Hands-On Skills: Pad Making at Buyala Primary:** In partnership with the Hug Foundation, we conducted a vocational training session at Buyala Primary School. We trained 100 girls and boys in the art of making reusable sanitary pads. By involving boys in this training, we are breaking down barriers and ensuring that the entire community understands and supports menstrual health as a basic necessity.
- **Drama for Change: Tackling Teenage Pregnancy:** Art has the power to start difficult conversations. We developed and performed a community drama focused on the challenges of teenage pregnancy.
- **Changing Mindsets:** The performance was attended by parents, local leaders, and the wider community. It served as a bridge to discuss sensitive topics, encouraging parents to support their daughters and work together to keep girls in school and protected from early pregnancy.

"When a boy learns to make a pad, stigma dies. When a parent watches a drama about teenage pregnancy, a conversation begins. This is how we transform a village."



We'd like to thank all our donors for their support

Acknowledgements

The impact we celebrated this year was not the work of a single hand, but the result of a powerful collective. We wish to extend our deepest gratitude to those who stood with us.

Our Strategic Partners

To the organizations that provided the resources, expertise, and platforms to scale our vision:

- The MTN Foundation & Maendeleo Foundation: For your commitment to bridging the digital divide and empowering 140 youth and women with the tools of the future.
- The Shared Sights Foundation: For walking with us into rural schools to mentor 100 student leaders and advocate for disability inclusiveness.
- The Hug Foundation: For your partnership at Buyala Primary, turning the "Kickout Period Poverty" vision into a tangible skill for 100 students.
- Period Talk: For providing the essential Menstrual Hygiene Health (MHH) support and expertise that kept our girls in school.

Our Leadership & Visionaries

- Denis Omedi (Goodwill Ambassador): Thank you for using your voice and influence to champion the Kickout Period Poverty campaign. Your leadership has been instrumental in bringing men and boys into this vital conversation.
- The UN Youth Awards Committee: We are honored by your recognition of "My Period, My Tree." This award belongs to the resilient communities of Eastern Uganda.

Our Global & Local Volunteers

- The Spanish Volunteer Team: A special thank you to our friends from Spain who traveled across borders to share their technical knowledge in plastic waste management. You turned our "Waste to Wealth" dream into a reality.
- The 40 Youth Volunteers: To the young men and women who picked up tools for our hospital and school clean-ups—you are the living proof of the power of the SDGs.

Our Dedicated Schools & Institutions

- St. Stephen's SS and Buyala Primary School: Thank you to the administrations, the 100 prefects, and the 150 students who embraced our training with open hearts and minds.
- Our Local Public Hospital: For allowing us to serve and for your partnership in prioritizing community health and sanitation.

To Our Donors & GoFundMe Supporters

To every individual who contributed a dollar, a kit, or a tree: You are the fuel behind our mission. Whether you supported us through our GoFundMe page or through direct contributions, please know that your generosity has been converted into dignity, education, and environmental restoration.

A Note to Our Trustees & Team

To our staff and board members who worked tirelessly behind the scenes through every challenge and opportunity—your resilience is the foundation of this organization.

"We thank God for the strength to serve, and we thank YOU for the partnership that makes change possible."